

Pragmatics Survey Questionnaire: The Nigerian Greeting "Have You Eaten?"

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1 Survey Overview

This questionnaire forms part of the study **"Between Care and 'Billing': Decoding Linguistic Masking and Transnational Identity in the Nigerian Greeting 'Have You Eaten?'"**

It is a structured pragmatic questionnaire examining frequency of greeting use, perceived communicative intention, affective meaning, reactions to an explicit hunger scenario, subsequent response strategies, and perceptions of economic influence.

Study Specification	Detail
Sample size	N = 100
Eligibility	Nigerian adults, aged 30–50 years
Residence status	60 diaspora participants (60%) / 40 residents in Nigeria (40%)
Sampling	Purposive and snowball sampling
Design	Quantitative, cross-sectional survey
Analysis	Descriptive statistics; Wilson 95% CIs; exact binomial test; Pearson's χ^2 with Cramér's V

Instructions to respondents: Please answer all questions honestly. There are no right or wrong

answers. Question Q4 allows you to select more than one option; all other items require a single response unless otherwise indicated.

2 Section A – Demographic Information

Please provide the following background information:

A1. Age group - 30–39 years - 40–50 years

A2. Current place of residence - I currently live in Nigeria - I currently live outside Nigeria (diaspora)

A3. Nigerian identity - I identify as Nigerian

All 100 participants in the final sample were aged 30–50, identified as Nigerian, and comprised 60 diaspora residents and 40 residents of Nigeria.

3 Section B – Pragmatic Questionnaire Items (Q1 to Q6)

Q1. How often do you use the greeting "Have you eaten?" as a greeting or conversation starter?

- ☐ Always – (10% of respondents)
- ☐ Often – (50%)
- ☐ Sometimes – (40%)
- ☐ Rarely
- ☐ Never

Q2. What do you consider the primary intention behind your use of "Have you eaten?"?

- ☐ Genuinely showing care and concern – (40%)
- ☐ Initiating conversation or small talk – (20%)
- ☐ Social expectation or habit – (30%)
- ☐ Checking on the interlocutor's well-being – (10%)

Q3. "Have you eaten?" conveys affection comparable to other culturally recognized expressions of interpersonal care (such as saying "I love you").

- ☐ Strongly Agree – (100%)
- ☐ Agree
- ☐ Neutral
- ☐ Disagree
- ☐ Strongly Disagree

Q4. If someone replies to your greeting with "No o, I'm seriously hungry," what would your likely reaction(s) be? (You may select more than one option.)

- ☐ Surprise – (50%)
- ☐ Neutral / Amused – (40%)

- ☐ Empathetic / willing to help – (20%)
- ☐ Anxious about being "billed" – (10%)

Note: this is a multiple-response item; percentages sum to more than 100%.

Q5. When someone tells you they are hungry, what do you typically do? (Select one.)

- ☐ Offer verbal comfort or religious reassurance – (65%)
- ☐ Change the topic – (15%)
- ☐ Offer food or money – (10%)
- ☐ Other – (10%)

Q6. Has Nigeria's current economic situation changed the way people use or interpret this greeting?

- ☐ No, it is still used traditionally regardless of the economy – (70%)
- ☐ Yes, people are more cautious because they might be "billed" – (5%)
- ☐ Not sure – (25%)

4 Response Distribution Summary

The table below summarizes the observed response distribution for each questionnaire item based on the processed survey data (N = 100).

Item	Construct	Observed Distribution
Q1	Frequency of greeting use	Always 10% · Often 50% · Sometimes 40%
Q2	Primary communicative intention	Genuine care 40% · Small talk 20% · Social expectation/habit 30% · Checking well-being 10%
Q3	Affective endorsement	Strongly Agree 100% (Wilson 95% CI: 96.3–100%)
Q4	Reactions to hunger disclosure (multiple response)	Surprise 50% · Neutral/Amused 40% · Empathetic/help-oriented 20% · "Billing" anxiety 10%
Q5	Typical response strategy	Verbal/religious reassurance 65% (CI: 55.3–73.6%) · Topic change 15% · Offer food/money 10% · Other 10%
Q6	Perceived economic influence	Traditional use unchanged 70% · More cautious 5% · Unsure 25%

Key inferential results reported in the study: the 65% verbal/religious reassurance rate differed significantly from an equal-probability reference distribution across the four Q5 categories (exact binomial test, $p < .001$), and residence status was not significantly associated with Q5 response strategy, $\chi^2(3) = 0.34$, $p = .952$, Cramér's $V = .058$ – indicating relative translocal continuity between diaspora and resident respondents.

5 Figures

The following figures visualize the questionnaire response distributions and are reproduced from the analysis of the processed survey data.

5.1 Figure 1 – General Use and Primary Communicative Intention (Q1 & Q2)

Figure 1

5.2 Figure 2 – The Affective–Material Gap (Q3 vs. Q5)

Figure 2

5.3 Figure 3 – Reaction Profiles to Explicit Hunger Disclosure (Q4)

Figure 3

5.4 Figure 4 – Response Strategies by Residence Status (Q5)

Figure 4